

UNIT-1

UNDERSTANDING THE LIFE SKILL MANAGEMENT

LIFE SKILL MANAGEMENT

INTRODUCTION:

The term 'Life Skills' refers to the skills you need to make the most out of life.

Any skill that is useful in your life can be considered a life skill. Tying your shoe laces, swimming, driving a car and using a computer are, for most people, useful life skills. Broadly speaking, the term 'life skills' is usually used for any of the skills needed to deal well and effectively with the challenges of life.

It should therefore be clear that everyone will potentially have a different list of the skills they consider most essential in life, and those that they consider unnecessary. Someone living in a remote rural community might put driving a car high on their list of essential skills. A Londoner or New Yorker, however, would probably rank that pretty low.

Defining Essential Life Skills

There is no definitive list of life skills.

Certain skills may be more or less relevant to you depending on your life circumstances, your culture, beliefs, age, geographic location, etc. However, in 1999, the World Health Organization identified six key areas of life skills:

- **Communication and interpersonal skills.** This broadly describes the skills needed to get on and work with other people, and particularly to transfer and receive messages either in writing or verbally.
- **Decision-making and problem-solving.** This describes the skills required to understand problems, find solutions to them, alone or with others, and then take action to address them.
- **Creative thinking and critical thinking.** This describes the ability to think in different and unusual ways about problems, and find new solutions, or generate new ideas, coupled with the ability to assess information carefully and understand its relevance.
- **Self-awareness and empathy,** which are two key parts of emotional intelligence. They describe understanding yourself and being able to feel for other people as if their experiences were happening to you.
- **Assertiveness and equanimity, or self-control.** These describe the skills needed to stand up for yourself and other people, and remain calm even in the face of considerable provocation.
- **Resilience and ability to cope with problems,** which describes the ability to recover from setbacks, and treat them as opportunities to learn, or simply experiences.

It is also true that different life skills will be more or less relevant at different times your life. For example:

- When at school or university, you'll need study skills. These may include understanding how to organize you for study, do research, and even write up a dissertation or thesis. These are not skills that everyone will need, but writing skills are likely to be useful in a variety of careers and jobs.
- When buying a house, you may need to employ negotiation skills, and you will certainly need plenty of patience and good temper. These skills are also likely to be high on your 'essential life skills' list if you have children!
- You'll need to work on your employability skills to get a job, and will also need to think about how you apply for a job, and how you might cope in an interview;
- When you have a job, you may need to develop leadership skills, especially if you need to lead teams or groups;
- When you start a family, you'll need parenting skills. You may also find that time management and organizing skills become much more important.

By learning new skills, we increase our understanding of the world around us and equip ourselves with the tools we need to live a more productive and fulfilling life, finding ways to cope with the challenges that life, inevitably, throws at us.

Most people associate learning with a formal education, but learning can, and should, be a lifelong process that enhances our understanding of the world and improves the quality of our life.

It will be clear that Skills You Need has many pages that can help you to develop these important life skills, and lots more.

These skills fall into a number of areas, including personal skills, interpersonal skills, writing skills and numeracy skills. Each of us already has a number of these skills; equally, we will all recognize that there are particular areas that could be improved.

Personal Skills

Personal skills are the essential life skills we need to help maintain a healthy body and mind.

These skills include many of those on the World Health Organization's list, such as resilience, self-control and self-awareness. They include skills such as how we recognise, manage and cope with emotions. You can find out more about your personality type on our page Myers-Briggs Type Indicators (MBTI) and our page Keeping your Mind Healthy is also worth a read.

Being able to manage anger and stress can also be essential life skills. Learning about anger and stress, recognising what may trigger them (in ourselves and others), what the symptoms are and how to control or manage such emotions can greatly enhance the quality of our lives. You can find more

about how to cope with stress in our pages on Stress and Managing Stress. We also have a section on Anger and Anger Management.

Many people battle with low self-esteem and confidence, which can cause stress and prevent them from reaching their full potential. Our pages Improving Self-Esteem and Building Confidence provide practical ways to overcome these issues.

Our personal skills pages also contain a section on Caring for your Body, including more on the importance of food, diet and nutrition, and why and how you should exercise to remain healthy.

Interpersonal and Communication Skills

The second important area of life skills is interpersonal and communication skills. These are the skills that we use to make connections with other people and are therefore an important part of what makes us human.

Communication skills are generally seen as a subset of interpersonal skills, as are decision-making and problem-solving, but both are important enough to consider in their own right too.

This is such a huge area that you may find that it is worth taking our Interpersonal Skills Self-Assessment Test to find out how good your listening and other interpersonal skills are.

Communication and other interpersonal skills cover a huge range of skills, including:

Effective listening skills, together with techniques such as clarification and reflection, can help prevent misunderstanding.

Verbal and non-verbal communication, include both how to use your voice and choose the right words, and also the use of tone of voice, body language and how you dress. They can help to build rapport.

Unfortunately, there are also many barriers to effective communication in any communication situation. These can lead to misunderstanding or even conflict.

Literacy: Reading and Writing Skills

Most people communicate, at least some of the time, using the written word—through letters, emails, reports, text messages, social network feeds and a host of other methods.

Being able to write clearly and concisely is a very powerful way to communicate, either one-to-one or to a much larger audience. We provide articles that will help you to improve your written communication and learn or refresh your knowledge on some of the fundamental rules of writing.

Our Writing Skills section includes lots of help and practical advice to help you improve your writing.

Numeracy Skills

Many people struggle with maths or numeracy. Developing or refreshing your numeracy skills, however, can give you a real boost in life. Better numeracy skills can:

- Make you more employable;
- Help you to develop a better understanding of the world around you;
- Save you time and money; and even
- Improve your mental health.

We don't all need to be great mathematicians, and we're certainly not all rocket scientists, but an understanding of the basic principles of day-to-day numeracy, arithmetic and maths will help to open many doors.

See our Numeracy Skills section for easy-to-follow, real-world examples of basic numeracy. There is plenty there about particular areas of maths that may be a struggle. The section also contains useful information about real-world maths, including budgeting, understanding interest, and loans and savings, all of which could save you money in both the short and longer term.

Lifelong learning and personal development

When you look at this list, it will probably be clear why a willingness to learn may be the most important life skill of all!

There are so many important life skills, but it is also important to remember that you have been developing these skills since you were born. Continuing to learn and grow is only an ongoing part of that process.

DEVELOPING AN IDENTITY:

- Research your audience, value proposition, and competition.
- Design the logo and a template for it.
- Integrate language you can use to connect, advertise, and embody on social media.
- Know what to avoid.
- Monitor your brand to maintain its brand identity.

UNDERSTANDING SELF

1. Mental process of a person who comprehends; comprehension; personal interpretation: My understanding of the word does not agree with yours.

2. Intellectual faculties; intelligence; mind: a quick understanding.

3. Superior power of discernment; enlightened intelligence: With her keen understanding she should have become a leader.

4. Knowledge of or familiarity with a particular thing; skill in dealing with or handling something: an understanding of accounting practice.

5. A state of cooperative or mutually tolerant relations between people: To him, understanding and goodwill were the supreme virtues.

PSYCHOLOGICAL PROBLEMS: Types of mental health problems

If you've been diagnosed with a mental health problem you might be looking for information on your diagnosis, treatment options and where to go for support. Our information pages will help you learn more.

Anger

Explains what anger is, and how to deal with it in a constructive and healthy way.

Anxiety and panic attacks

Explains anxiety and panic attacks, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Bipolar disorder

Explains what bipolar disorder is, what kinds of treatment are available, and how you can help yourself cope. Also provides guidance on what friends and family can do to help.

Body dysmorphic disorder (BDD)

Explains body dysmorphic disorder, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Borderline personality disorder (BPD)

Explains what BPD is and what it's like to live with this diagnosis. Also provides information about self-care, treatment and recovery, and gives guidance on how friends and family can help.

Depression

Explains depression, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Dissociation and dissociative disorders

Explains dissociative disorders, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Drugs - recreational drugs & alcohol

Explains the mental health effects of recreational drugs and alcohol, and what might happen if you use recreational drugs and also have a mental health problem. Includes suggestions for where you might find support.

Eating problems

Explains eating problems, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Hearing voices

Explains what it is like to hear voices, where to go for help if you need it, and what others can do to support someone who is struggling with hearing voices.

Hoarding

Explains hoarding, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Hypomania and mania

Explains hypomania and mania, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Loneliness

Explains loneliness, giving practical suggestions for what you can do and where you can go for support.

Mental health problems - introduction

Explains what mental health problems are, what may cause them, and the many different kinds of help, treatment and support that are available. Also provides guidance on where to find more information, and tips for friends and family.

Obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD)

Explains obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD), including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Panic attacks

Explains what panic attacks are, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Paranoia

Explains paranoia, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Personality disorders

Explains personality disorders, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support.

Phobias

Explains phobias, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Postnatal depression & perinatal mental health

Explains postnatal depression and other perinatal mental health issues, including possible causes, sources of treatment and support. Also gives advice for friends and family.

Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD)

Explains what post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) and complex PTSD are, and provides information on how you can access treatment and support. Includes self-care tips and guidance for friends and family.

Premenstrual dysphoric disorder (PMDD)

Explains what PMDD is and explores issues around getting a diagnosis. Also provides information on self care and treatment options, and how friends and family can help.

Psychosis

Explains what psychosis is, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Schizoaffective disorder

Explains what schizoaffective disorder is, including its symptoms and causes. Gives advice on how you can help yourself and what types of treatment and support are available, as well as guidance for friends and family.

Schizophrenia

Explains schizophrenia, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Seasonal affective disorder (SAD)

Explains seasonal affective disorder, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Self-esteem

Explains how to increase your self-esteem, giving practical suggestions for what you can do and where you can go for support.

Self-harm

Explains self-harm, including possible causes and how you can access treatment and support. Includes tips for helping yourself, and guidance for friends and family.

Sleep problems

Explains insomnia and other sleep problems, giving practical suggestions for what you can do and where you can go for support.

Stress

Explains what stress is, what might cause it and how it can affect you. Includes information about ways you can help yourself and how to get support.

Suicidal feelings

Explains what suicidal feelings are, including possible causes and how you can learn to cope.

Tardive dyskinesia

Explains what tardive dyskinesia is, what causes it and what you can do to manage it.

Trauma

Explains what trauma is and how it affects your mental health, including how you can help yourself, what treatments are available and how to overcome barriers to getting the right support. Also includes tips for people who want to support someone who has gone through trauma.

INTRODUCTION OF Psychological disorders

Psychological disorders, also referred to as mental disorders, are abnormalities of the mind that result in persistent behavior patterns that can seriously affect your day-to-day function and life. Many different psychological disorders have been identified and classified, including eating disorders, such as anorexia nervosa; mood disorders, such as depression; personality disorders, such as antisocial personality disorder; psychotic disorders, such as schizophrenia; sexual disorders, such as sexual dysfunction; and others. Multiple psychological disorders may exist in one person.

The specific causes of psychological disorders are not known, but contributing factors may include chemical imbalances in the brain, childhood experiences, heredity, illnesses, prenatal exposures, and

stress. Some disorders, such as borderline personality and depression, occur more frequently in women. Others, such as intermittent explosive disorder and substance abuse, are more common in men. Still other disorders, such as bipolar disorder and schizophrenia, affect men and women in roughly equal proportions.

When a person experiences mood or cognitive problems or behavioral issues for a long time, a psychological evaluation may be beneficial, and a diagnosis of a psychological disorder may follow. Treatment frequently involves psychotherapy to work on behaviors, skill development, and thought process. A person may be hospitalized for coexisting medical problems, serious complications, severe disorders, or substance abuse. Medications can be quite helpful for some psychological disorders.

Properly treated, people who have psychological disorders often improve; however, relapses are possible. Left untreated, some psychological problems can lead to academic, legal, social and work problems. Alcohol poisoning, drug overdose, suicide, and violent behavior are other potential complications.

Psychological disorders can have serious, even life-threatening, complications. Seek immediate medical care (call 911) for inability to care for one's basic needs (food, water, shelter) or threatening, irrational or suicidal behavior.

Seek prompt medical care if you think you might have a psychological disorder or are being treated for one but symptoms recur or are persistent.

Symptoms

Symptoms of psychological disorders vary based on the specific disorder, but mood and behavioral symptoms are common. Symptoms can be chronic and relapsing. They can interfere with your ability to interact in society. Some psychological disorders can also cause physical symptoms. For example, panic attacks associated with anxiety disorders may have symptoms that look and feel like a heart attack. Somatoform disorders, conditions in which symptoms suggest a medical cause but none can be found, frequently involve symptoms of pain or achiness.

Common symptoms of psychological disorders

Psychological disorders can cause a variety of symptoms; common symptoms include:

- Agitation, hostility or aggression
- Alcohol or drug abuse
- Alterations in energy levels
- Anxiety
- Confusion or disconnectedness
- Erratic behavior
- Irritability and mood changes
- Perception or thought process disturbances (psychoses), such as hallucinations and delusions

- Persistent or abrupt mood changes that can interfere with day-to-day life
- Problem denial
- Social withdrawal

Physical symptoms that may accompany psychological disorders

Psychological disorders may also be associated with physical symptoms including:

- Inexplicable physical problems
- Lethargy or malaise
- Sleep disturbances
- Weight and appetite changes

Serious symptoms that might indicate a life-threatening condition

In some cases, psychological disorders can be life threatening. Seek immediate medical care (call 911) if you, or someone you are with, have any of these life-threatening symptoms including:

- Being a danger to oneself or others, including threatening, irrational or suicidal behavior
- Inability to care for one's basic needs
- Trauma, such as bone deformity, burns, eye injuries, and other injuries

Causes

What causes psychological disorders?

The causes of psychological disorders are not known, but a number of factors are thought to influence their development. These factors include chemical imbalances in the brain, childhood experiences, heredity, illnesses, prenatal exposures, and stress. Gender plays a role in some, but not all, psychological disorders.

What are the risk factors for psychological disorders?

A number of factors increase the risk of developing psychological disorders. Not all people with risk factors will get psychological disorders. Risk factors for psychological disorders include:

- Abuse or neglect as a child
- Childhood problems with temperament
- Family or personal history of mental illness or substance abuse
- Intelligence below normal
- Low birth weight
- Lower socioeconomic status
- Parental absence, criminal activity, or substance abuse
- Prenatal exposures, such as to alcohol or drugs
- Significant medical conditions, such as cancer, chronic pain, and hypothyroidism

- Social disadvantage
- Stressful or traumatic life events
- Substance abuse

Treatments

How are psychological disorders treated?

The first step in the treatment of psychological disorders is recognizing that a problem exists. Often, people who have psychological disorders deny their problem and do not seek medical care for their symptoms. Regular medical care can be helpful because it allows a health care professional to provide early screening tests. Regular medical care also provides an opportunity for your health care professional to promptly evaluate symptoms and your risks for developing psychological disorders.

Treatment frequently involves psychotherapy to work on behaviors, skill development, and thought process. Initial hospitalization may be necessary for coexisting medical problems, serious complications, severe disorders, or substance abuse. Medications can be quite helpful for some personality disorders. Significant improvement can occur with proper treatment.

Common treatments for psychological disorders

Common treatments of psychological disorders include:

- Antianxiety medications
- Antidepressant medications to improve moods
- Antipsychotic medications to treat disordered thought patterns and altered perceptions
- Cognitive behavioral therapy to work on thought patterns and behavior
- Family therapy to help develop support and understanding
- Group therapy
- Hospitalization for coexisting medical problems, serious complications, severe disorders, or substance abuse
- Identification and treatment of coexisting conditions
- Individual therapy
- Mood-stabilizing medications
- Psychodynamic therapy to work on discovering and understanding past issues and their relationship to current thoughts and behaviors
- Support groups
- Talk therapy

What you can do to improve your psychological disorders

In addition to seeking and receiving treatment, you may be able to improve your symptoms and decrease your risk of recurrence by:

- Avoiding alcohol or illicit drug use
- Avoiding caffeine or other stimulants
- Eating on a regular schedule
- Exercising regularly
- Getting enough sleep
- Keeping appointments and taking medications as directed

What are the potential complications of psychological disorders?

Complications of untreated or poorly controlled psychological disorders can be serious, even life threatening in some cases. You can help minimize your risk of serious complications by following the treatment plan you and your health care professional design specifically for you. Complications of psychological disorders include:

- Adverse effects of treatment
- Difficulties with the law, at work, in social environments, with relationships, and with finances
- Increased risk of injury
- Medical complications specific to behaviors associated with psychological disorders
- Self-harm
- Social isolation
- Strained family relationships
- Substance abuse
- Suicide or violence

CONCEPTS OF LIFE SKILLS:

- Critical Thinking
- Creative Thinking
- Decision Making
- Problem Solving
- Interpersonal Relationship
- Effective Communication
- Coping With Emotions
- Coping With Stress
- Self Awareness
- Empathy

Human Brain Structure and Their Functions In Human Body

Introduction: The most important and perhaps the most complex organ of human body is the brain. It controls all senses and functions of the body. Human brain weighs about 3 lbs. and is enclosed in a hard bony shell for protection, called skull. Interpreting information collected from different parts of

the body and preparing the body for the generation of an appropriate response are some of the physiological tasks of the brain. Cerebrum, cerebellum, diencephalon and brainstem are the primary brain divisions.

For centuries, researchers and scientists have been trying their best to thoroughly explore the human brain structure, but until recently they have been unable to examine it completely and think it something very hard to accomplish. In fact, many of its functions still remain least understood, such as thinking.

Human Brain Structure and Functions:

Based on their placement in the front, middle or back areas of skull, the human brain can be divided into three major parts, namely, forebrain, midbrain and hindbrain. These broad divisions are comprised of different smaller divisions, with each having a specific role to play. It oft happens that different parts share responsibility for the completion of the same task. In this way, the overall job of the brain is done in a beautiful manner. In case of a disorder or malfunctioning of any of the structures, the diagnosis is usually a very complex and demanding task. So, you should take special care of this organ. Knowledge of the structure and function of various brain divisions will help you in this regard.

Forebrain – Center for Processing Sensory Information:

The forebrain is considered as the most important part of brain because, on account of its functioning, it distinguishes human from other animals. This part is responsible for processing sensory information, collected by different sensory organs, such as eyes, nose, ears, tongue and skin. It is further divided into two parts, namely, diencephalon and telencephalon. The diencephalon contains thalamus and hypothalamus which control sensory and autonomic processes. Telencephalon contains the biggest part of brain, called cerebrum.

Midbrain – Mediating between Hindbrain and Forebrain:

The midbrain acts as a bridge to transmit signals from hindbrain and forebrain. These signals mostly come from the senses of touch and hearing, collected by the specialized organs, i.e. skin and ears, respectively. The upper part of the midbrain is called optic tectum, which serves to integrate visionary and auditory data.

Hindbrain – Control Center for Visceral Functions:

The hindbrain can be further divided into 3 parts: medulla oblongata, pons and cerebellum. The main function of this human brain structure is to control certain visceral functions in body (including heart rate, breathing and blood pressure). Looking at the tasks assigned to pons, it serves to monitor the sleep and waking up functions while working in coordination with other parts of the nervous system. The cerebellum co-ordinates the movements of arms and legs and also plays a role in processing the sensory information that it receives from visual and auditory systems.

Other Brain Divisions and Their Functions:

Apart from the basic divisions of forebrain, midbrain and hindbrain, the master organ of your body can also be divided along other dimensions. Here follows a precise description of some structurally and functionally important parts of the brain.

The Cortex – Regulation of Voluntary Movements:

Also known as the cerebral cortex, it is the outermost layer of the neural tissues in the cerebrum. The medial longitudinal fissure divides the cortex into two major components, that is, right cerebral hemisphere and left cerebral hemisphere. On the basis of function, it is said to be comprised of motor areas, sensory areas and association areas. Located in both the hemispheres of the cortex, the motor areas are concerned with the regulation of voluntary movements. The right side of your body is controlled by the left half of this area and vice versa. As the name indicates, the sensory areas are associated with the processing of data received from the senses. The primary function of the association areas, on the other hand, is to assist abstract thinking and language. They also help you in producing a meaningful perceptual experience of the world around you.

Brainstem – Regulation of Sleep & Breathing:

Comprised of hindbrain, medulla and pons, the brainstem is the posterior most part of the brain that extends backward to join the spinal cord. This small structure carries much importance in the brain as it provides passage for the nerve connections of sensory and motor systems. The basic functions of brainstem include the control of sleep and breathing.

Lobes of Brain:

The human brain structure can also be divided into several different types of lobes, including parietal, occipital, frontal and temporal lobes. The management of body position, handwriting and sensation falls under the domain of parietal lobes. The occipital lobes house the visual processing system of the brain. The motor function, judgment and problem solving is accomplished in the frontal lobes. The temporal lobes of the brain are associated with the processing of memory and hearing.

Characteristics of healthy personality:

Adjusted- a mentally- healthy person is not unduly distressed by conflicts- not that he has no conflicts. He handles his conflicts in a realistic manner.

Productive- he has spontaneity in work and play. He uses his potentials to the full

Zest for living- he has a high energy level and can do hard work with enthusiasm. He is not easily discouraged.

A personality is a culmination of various qualities of a person which decides the mental constitution of that person. Every person has a peculiar personality. How people relate or retaliate to real life

situations makes their personalities different from each other. Those people who are well adjusted with the environment have healthy personalities. Their efficiency to do anything is greater than people with unhealthy personalities. Their life is harmonious and they have achieved a sense of peace between themselves and the world around them. Healthy personalities do not have any self-destructive feelings nor do they have feelings of guilt, shame, anxiety or anger because they do not feel inadequate or look at their life in the light of insufficiency. A healthy personality is flexible towards his environment and the people around him; he does not show any rigidity or redundancy in thoughts and actions. A person with a healthy personality moves forward with time and believes in progressive feelings and attitude. All of these qualities construe to the fact that a healthy personality is a personality with positive attitude and a realistic approach towards life. People with healthy personalities live a much healthier life, physically and emotionally. For example, a person with healthy personality has emotional stability, while a person with maladjusted personality is more prone to moodiness, anxiety, stress and negative thinking, which leads to neuroticism, and neuroticism affects the longevity and well being of a person. It is, therefore, suffice to say that people with healthy personalities get to live a long life with physical and mental wellness. A person with well-adjusted personality also has a peculiar trait that he interprets his environment exactly how it is and he knows his strength and weakness in their true capacity. Here are some invaluable quotes about personality that will change your life. To understand a healthy personality in depth, let us study its various characteristics.

Traits of A Healthy Personality

Rational Self Evaluation: A person with healthy personality looks at himself with realistic approach, for who he really is and not what he would like to be. There is a considerable amount of gap between what is real and what is idealistic in his mind. A person with healthy personality is not guarded or defensive towards others because he does not try to defend himself against the world. He knows his true abilities and inabilities; therefore there is no façade of defense mechanism to try and save himself of the embarrassment of the failures by not taking the responsibility of it and putting it on others. Every criticism for a person with well adjusted personality is constructive criticism. He is willing to listen to others criticize him, knowing that it will make him a better person.

Rational Evaluation Of Rewards: A person with healthy personality will realistically appraise his achievements. His reaction towards them would be pragmatic and he will not get attached to it beyond a healthy measure. It is a trait of a person with unhealthy personality that he takes his rewards too personally and tries to force his superiority over others. This kind of unadjusted person will throw around his weight, brag about his success and make other people feel low about themselves. Someone with healthy personality will always take his success and failure with a pinch of salt and try and evaluate himself realistically. If he has achieved success, he will not let this get to his head and if he has failed then also he will look at the situation for what it is, trying to assess if the failure was because other people in the competition were better than him.

Agreeing With Reality: The well-adjusted person will know about his limitations, whether physical or mental. The fact that he has clarity about his weaknesses, he will be able to improve himself. On the other hand a person with unhealthy personality will always feel self pity for having some sort of limitation and will play the blame game. This will affect his life massively because he will never be able to find ways to compensate for his shortcomings.

Being Responsible: A person with healthy personality recognizes his responsibilities and will always be ready to give in his all to fulfill his duties. He is well aware of the fact that by denying his responsibilities he would have to face social disapproval, which will inevitably affect his confidence levels. He takes responsibility for himself and his actions. If it is his fault then he accepts it gracefully without unnecessarily fighting it. A well-adjusted personality will always admit his mistake. This makes him a reliable person.

Emotional Stability: A person with well-adjusted personality always keeps a check on his emotions, making sure that they are not going out of control and are not hurting anybody else or himself. This kind of person is very comfortable with his emotions and does not hesitate in expressing his emotions in healthy amount. He has, over the period of his life, inculcated in his personality tolerance against stress, depression and anxiety.

Focused: A person with healthy personality will always keep realistic and pragmatic goals, knowing what he can or cannot achieve. While a person with distorted personality will always fail to keep realistic goals for himself, he would constantly either underestimate or overestimate himself. A person with healthy personality is generally organized with his goals while the maladjusted one will not be able to keep his focus and all his resources will be scattered because he would have no clue how to fulfill his unrealistic goal.

Acceptance: A person with healthy personality will always have confidence that he will be able to meet social demands and challenges and he will work hard towards achieving it. He will not live his life primarily for social acceptance but will have full faith in his personality that he will be accepted everywhere he will go. On the other hand, the maladjusted personality will either go out of his way to try and achieve social acceptance or will outspokenly detest it.

Anxiety: Signs, symptoms and risk factors

Your heart starts to feel like it's coming right out of your chest. Your hands are clammy and maybe start to tremble. Worst of all, your head feels as though it could explode. These are just some of the signs and symptoms of anxiety.

At some point in our lives, we all experience anxiety and learn how to deal with anxiety. Unfortunately, some of us are better at this than others. Anxiety can be occasional or even rare, or it can be daily and become a regular part of our lives. But in both cases, anxiety is a serious health concern and there are many different anxiety disorders you could have. Here is some important

information that you should know about anxiety so you not only understand but can even learn how to deal with anxiety yourself.

What is anxiety?

Link between stress and hypertension We know what the stomach flu, a headache and even the common cold is, but anxiety is not often understood as well as other illnesses. So to better understand anxiety, let's examine the definition of anxiety.

According to the Mayo Clinic, the definition of anxiety is when individuals experience excessive worry and fear when it comes to everyday life. Furthermore, this worry and fear interferes with life and can become hard to control. Signs and symptoms of anxiety can last temporarily or can be ongoing, depending on the anxiety disorder.

Some forms of anxiety disorders are social anxiety disorder, where people become anxious in social environments, and separation anxiety where the anxiety stems from being separated either from a person or a beloved possession. As mentioned, anxiety disorders can take a toll on a person's life, so understanding where they come from is the beginning of seeking treatment.

Risk factors of anxiety

risks-factors-of-anxiety Even though anyone can experience anxiety at any given moment, there are a few risk factors of anxiety to look out for. Some of these risk factors of anxiety include:

Personality: Certain personalities, like being introverted, are more prone to developing anxiety disorders.

Substance abuse: Withdrawal from substances or continued alcohol and drug abuse can lead to anxiety disorders.

Being female: Statistics reveal that anxiety disorders most commonly occur in women.

Trauma: Childhood or even adult trauma can develop into anxiety disorders.

Stress: Whether it is stress due to a pre-existing illness, or stress from everyday life, stress is a large risk factor for anxiety.

Mental Health issues: Pre-existing mental health disorders, like depression, are among the top risk factors of anxiety.

Family members: People who have family members with anxiety disorders are at higher risk of developing it themselves.

Pre-existing medical conditions can also bring on anxiety. Some medical conditions that can lead to anxiety disorders are heart disease, diabetes, asthma, irritable bowel syndrome (IBS) and thyroid problems.

These are some of the most common risk factors of anxiety and should be considered when attempting to diagnose or treat anxiety.

Signs and symptoms of anxiety

Now that we understand what the definition of anxiety is, as well as risk factors of anxiety, let's examine the signs and symptoms of anxiety. Common signs and symptoms of anxiety include:

- Nervousness
- Feelings of being powerless
- Feelings of impending danger
- Increased heart rate
- Hyperventilation (heavy breathing)
- Sweating
- Trembling
- Weakness and fatigue
- Lack of concentration and focus other than the cause of worry.

The signs and symptoms of anxiety also greatly affect the body's systems. For example, anxiety disorders can disrupt the digestive system, the cardiovascular system, respiratory response, nervous system and immune system. All these major systems become affected when anxiety hits which can lead to poorer health over time.

Signs and symptoms of anxiety can also affect a person's behavior. Some behavioral signs and symptoms of anxiety include:

- Repetitive or compulsive behaviors
- Changes in personality
- Relationship problems
- Issues at the workplace
- Wanting to remain isolated
- Increased fear of situations or doing things.

As you can see, the signs and symptoms of anxiety truly take a large toll on the body as a whole and the individual, changing them as a person. Because of these significant changes, anxiety can transform a person into someone else and inhibit their ability to function.

Types of anxiety disorders

Although a few anxiety disorders have been mentioned, the list is actually quite long. When it comes to anxiety disorders, here are some of the more common ones:

- Selective mutism: The individual cannot speak in certain environments but can speak when around those who are close to them.
- Specific phobia: The anxiety is developed when the person is near something they are greatly afraid of.
- Social anxiety disorder: High level of anxiety being in social situations. This anxiety disorder makes the person feel they are being judged or looked down upon.
- Panic disorder: Episodes of intense anxiety which can result in an anxiety attack.
- Generalized anxiety disorder: Constant anxiety over daily life events.
- Substance-induced anxiety: Anxiety brought on by alcohol or drugs.
- Agoraphobia: Anxiety about places or visiting places and then losing control and bring on feelings of being trapped.
- Separation anxiety disorder: Commonly found in children, it brings on anxiety from the fear of losing parents or parental figures.

How to deal with anxiety

Because there is such a large number of anxiety disorders, how to deal with anxiety may not be the same for every person. Common forms of treatment on how to deal with anxiety include the use of medications, such as antidepressants, as well as psychotherapy, which allows the individual to talk with someone to determine the cause of their anxiety and work through it.

There are also natural ways that can help someone deal with anxiety. Some of these methods are:

- Exercise: Exercising releases mood-boosting hormones, making us feel happier and more positive. It also reduces stress and clears the mind.
- Avoid substances: If alcohol and drugs are the cause of your anxiety, or make it worse, staying off these substances is vital.
- Reduce the use of stimulants: Smoking and caffeine can make an anxious person even more so, so quitting or cutting down caffeine intake are a must.
- Meditate: Relaxation methods like meditation are useful to reduce stress.
- Sleep: A good night's rest is important to feeling refreshed and calming your mind.
- Food: Well-balanced meals, including lean proteins, fruits and vegetables, can work to reduce anxiety.

Managing your anxiety is the key to overall well-being. Because anxiety disorders can take such a large toll on the body and all its major systems, finding an effective treatment is highly important.

Understanding the underlying cause of your anxiety is the first step when it comes to how to deal with anxiety. From there, you can seek out the proper treatment you need for recovery.

Anxiety can truly hold a person hostage within their own mind and body, preventing the enjoyment of day-to-day life. It's very much a serious health condition and sharing your concerns may offer relief and the support you need to seek professional help.

If you have experienced any of the signs and symptoms of anxiety, or maybe have some of the risk factors of anxiety, take action to get yourself checked – so you can begin enjoying life once again.

Anger Management

1. Acknowledge That You Have a Problem.
2. Keep a Hostility Log.
3. Use Your Support Network.
4. Interrupt the Anger Cycle.
5. Use Empathy.
6. See the Humor in Your Anger.
7. Relax.
8. Build Trust.
9. Listen Effectively.
10. Be Assertive.